

(5) Session Five (Wanderhome 7-07-24)

Two years before the war's end

[Basil](#) is assisting some people in escaping to war by hosing them in his barn. He hears a very aggressive knock on the door, Basil politely opens it to an armadillo in their mid thirties. The armadillo is armored with a [symbol of a rising sun and bunny ears](#), another supervisor is with them. The supervisor warns of strange and dangerous individuals that may have crossed his fence. Basil replies "I'll keep an eye out" then [Rolls](#) a 2 for deception. The supervisor pushes past to do a full violent inspection of Basil's house. They are unable to find any evidence of stowaways "Listen, I know the floating mountain hasn't been the best for you, but I want what's best for you. If I go out to the barn will I find anyone?" says the older guard. Basil replies "I don't know, will you?" and gets decked immediately. Basil hopes that the bees will hide the stowaways and rolls an 8 to tough out the guard's abuse. Basil ends up getting knocked out, the guards check the barn and find nothing.

Present Day

The party is standing around the last remnant of [Basil](#): a pair of shining shears.

We take a moment to consider how we all process the death of Basil and any traits we may have gained.

[The Author](#)- Gains the **Nervous** trait while staring blankly at the space Basil once occupied.

[Percival \(REDACTED\)](#), [The Forgotten](#)- Gains the **Lost** trait while holding Basil's bees. He picks up the shears and examines them. They roll a 6 to investigate (fail) then bumps it to 8 or a mixed success. They roll again with disadvantage and get a 4. They come to the realization that Basil didn't have any magic or anything fancy, it was just a normal citizen with a passion for protecting. They sense that the shears have been enchanted with the power of Basil's passion and that wielding it may have the same result as Basil killing the [North Wind God](#). The rest of the party also sees this.

[Beau](#)- Gains the **Heroic** while shell-shocked by this death. He looks at the shears without emotion then turns to investigate the bodies.

[Solris](#)- Gains the **Feral** trait

[Hira](#)- Gains the **Empty** trait while kneeling on the ground holding Basil's handkerchief. This is the first time she's lost someone in a tangible way.

[Basil](#)- Gains the dead trait while dying.

[Beau](#) shatters the moment by saying "Hey come look at this body". In a commanding voice.

[Percival \(REDACTED\)](#), [The Forgotten](#) takes [Solris](#)' paw and breaks them out of their shell-

shock. They start whining and sadly follow them over to where the author already is. We see the body of an older gopher wearing the armor with the rising sun as well as a very young adult. Beau is very analytical and searches their pockets to find an old initialed chain with a brass heart as well as a letter from a sick sister from the older gentlemen. There is also a more official looking letter with the bodies. The Author goes back to sit with Hira who does not see them.

[Beau](#) sees the state [Solris](#) is in and instead hands the ledger to Percival. He reads what seems to be a scouting report with notes of when people were on the mountain and what they were doing. There is an entry from earlier in the day describing our party with the note "They seemed to be celebrating the [A Meteor Shower](#) before a fire started. We sent multiple rangers to help contain the fire, the party was nowhere to be found." Another later entry reads "There is a strange storm coming. Will report back soon." [Solris](#) rolls a 10 to notice that the ledger is written in a very nonchalant way and that these are probably the two weakest guard in the platoon with hastily put on armor. We confirm that the ledger was about to be sent to the county of Gizar in the main kingdom o Scoripass. These reports are regular, but important and the seal of the mountain king implies that suspicion will be raised if it isn't sent or if the guards don't return. [Percival \(REDACTED\)](#), [The Forgotten](#) writes down the address of the letter from the sick sister.

[The Author](#) takes [Hira](#)'s hand and guides them back to the group. Beau sticks by Hira to provide support if needed. As Hira passes by and takes in the bodies on the ground she says a last rites for the body. [Solris](#) positions themself at the front of the group to lead them back to [Solris' Lighthouse Longboat](#). The party rolls a mixed success on stealth, moving quickly but leaving a trace.

Once on the boat [Beau](#) boards without asking permission, upsetting [Solris](#), but they ignore it for now in favor of getting everyone safely on the boat. Beau states that if there isn't anything urgent that needs to be done we should all go to bed and get the boat moing. He offers to help steer. Solris doesn't respond to the offer and instead quietly hears everyone into the cabin before heading up to steer themself. [Percival \(REDACTED\)](#), [The Forgotten](#) takes a moment to check on Beau by saying "I've seen this before". Beau acknowledges the concern, but brushes it off with "I can handle myself". The party retires for the night. [Bigby the Big Bismuth Dragon](#) sleeps on the deck.

While [Hira](#) is asleep, they dream of floating in a vast ocean. They just float in this deep abyss. 'The camera zooms out' in this dreamscape to reveal the large dark shadow of a [jellyfish-like creature](#). The Sea Witch slowly breaches the water. Hira [Rolls](#) a nine and bumps it to a ten to investigate the Witch. Hira sees that the Witch is smiling with the knowledge that this is where Hira is weakest. Hira feels a ball of rage seething inside of her.

"Little guppy, I'm glad you're here"

"Fuck off"

The [Sea Witch](#) expresses a sadness with the loss of [Basil](#), but Hira knows it's with the sadness of losing a tool. Hira doesn't respond.

"Listen darling, I have not shown all my cards yet and I know there is some mistrust, but I'm not hiding things anymore"

The Witch expresses a desire to help Hira in order to help herself in not eradicating the gods, but simply making a better world for demons.

"And where do we fit in? How is this a better world or us?"

"The pains of the war were led by the gods. This is a new era for demons. We are more than just conniving spirits."

Hira understands the need for a better world, but doesn't believe that Kith will be protected in this. The Witch gives [Hira](#) more power with the offer of a relationship instead of a full pledge.

"What have I truly ever done to harm you?"

"What happens when I black out?"

"Who can blame a girl for simply wanting to see a little bit more? I know I don't ask for your permission, but I don't believe you would trust me with it. The world is changing. I can give you the power to change it for yourself, or I keep it for myself. I am giving you a choice here."

"want to make one thing clear. You say you will never expect me to fully devote myself to you, and I promise you that will never happen because I am devoted to my friends. I am going to continue on our quest, and I hope you're right that this will be a better world"

Hira knows that the quest has the power to bring back violence, but she also knows that she has the power to shape the world to her intentions with the implications that the [Sea Witch](#) can do the same.

"Our goals align enough for now that I will help you. But they always come first"

"Oh absolutely"

The Witch offers a ball of power, and Hira hesitates while remembering the good moments with her party, with Basil. She thinks about how the power could protect the friends she has left and touches the ball before waking up.

[Solris](#) hears sobbing from the cabin under his own coming from [Beau](#). They go quietly check on him to make sure he's safe, then

Elsewhere

An unknown character feels a strong wind before escaping it while flying their siblings. This character doesn't understand why everyone is choosing to go this way. They know their siblings have their own ways of getting around but this character moves like a paper airplane. They stop and break off from their siblings, floating down to a branch above the ship and unfold to reveal the god of knowledge. Instead of scribbled notes, they are now blank and featureless with fancy clothing. While most things have faded, they have kept a sense of pretentiousness. They take their time getting down from the tree. They acknowledge that the party on the boat are their best chance at help, but they don't quite trust them that and choose to follow the boat.

Morning

The party is awoken by the horrified and disgusted screams of [Bigby the Big Bismuth Dragon](#) and rush out onto the deck. [Beau](#) rushes out and instantly snipes [The God of Knowledge](#) out of the air. [Solris](#) checks to make sure Bigby isn't hurt before switching the [Heavenblade](#) into a bow and attempts to shoot the God (misses). Knowledge reaches the deck and Solris approaches with the bow drawn and demands "Why are you here?".

"Where should I be?"

Beau asks where the rest of the gods are. Knowledge seems confused by this. Solris goes to rush them, but is stopped by [Hira](#) "There are better ways to deal with this". Solris shakes her off. Beau gets tired of this and goes to cook breakfast. Solris refuses to let the God on the boat without an explanation and lets the god float away from the boat. Beau gestures for the god to stay near the boat and leaves to make scones. Beau is upset that we are being hypocritical by freeing the gods and then not allowing one to come with us. Solris agrees and acknowledges what Beau is saying but expresses that the problem isn't with that idea it's with Knowledge being on the boat with permission.

Beau takes Bigby and goes back to Knowledge with scones and the offer to try again.

Knowledge tells Beau that they can't eat. Beau is like "okay look lets practice asking to be on the boat" They try and it's creepy. Beau invites Knowledge onto Bigby who is struggling not to laugh. Knowledge agrees to try again and after a vote is granted access to the boat.

Later

Everyone is in the kitchen deciding what to do next. [Kago](#) tells the party that they talked to some gods while in the "bad mountain" and now feels a strong sense that there are gods up north. Knowledge cuts in with "That's where the gods went". Beau tells us that that's where he used to teach and that he has some "*friends*" there. [Percival \(REDACTED\)](#), [The Forgotten](#) has a strange reaction to this. There is a sense that he has a history there. Beau thinks that this is the next logical step with their journey. [Solris](#) asks if it's safe and Beau tells us that [The Floating Mountain King](#) is more present there and that we should watch what we say.

Downtime

The Author

Wants to figure out how to help Hira whether that is how to restrain her from harming, or how to kill her if needed

[Hira](#) sets the difficulty at five due to how closed off she is right now. The Author [Rolls](#) a 5. Hira learns to be calmer and control her magic and anxieties better.

Hira

Finishes their tract from last session learning about their mother. She learns that her mom is in the forest and that she was doing a lot of research on [The Slobbering God](#) including reaching out to someone called The Poet. Gains advantage with books and maps.

Percival (REDACTED), The Forgotten

Wants to train and learn how to move faster, specifically through shadows. Difficulty 3, [Rolls](#) a 6

They gain faster movement in battle and advantage with hiding and are immediately.

Solris

Boat renovation. At 3 we get waritems, 8 dragon bed, 10 training room rolls a 3 and pushes to a 4

[Beau](#) helps to finish the track. Solris now gains advantage on channeling [Bigby the Big Bismuth Dragon](#)'s power. Everyone else gains a plus one or two when using the training room.

Bigby the Big Bismuth Dragon

Boat renovations for better movement

Rolls a 5 for a difficulty of 15 bringing it down to 10

The God of Knowledge

Wants to understand

Rolls a 5 for a DC 4

They understand the party and our goal. Gains advantage when trying to figure someone else

The Bees

The bees make a declaration that they are leaving and creating their own nation: the Babasils. A whole army of bees flock away.

Downtime Two

The Author

Would like to make themselves a simple walking stick

Rolls a 1 on a DC 2

They almost finish the perfect walking stick, but then Bigby steps on it. The author is able to make a second one. They now get a little speed boost when moving.

Percival (REDACTED), The Forgotten

Wants to get to know Knowledge

Knowledge sets the difficulty at 4. Rolls a 1 and pushes to a 2

Solris

Wants to work with Bigby

Rolls a 4 on a 5

Solris gets to see Bigby in a calmer setting and focus on their relationship allowing Solris to do very simple magic.

Bigby rolls an 8 for boat expansion lowering the difficulty to 2

Hira

Wants to try getting used to her magic

Rolls a 6+2

They are now able to control water and gain more magic. They start creating their own magic without the witches power

The God of Knowledge

Wants to befriend Beau

Rolls a 6 on a DC 3

They apologize and Beau cries. Beau opens up about Omar Abdelhamid, a very good friend at the academy. He talks about how there was an event where Beau quickly stopped talking to Omar and left the academy. The God of Knowledge admits that they don't know their name, Beau offers to help come up with one.

Gateling

History Check: There is a kingdom of Scoripas and a main city. The city was the first to fall during the war by surrender. This is the best place to learn about [The Floating Mountain King](#) due to their direct control over this place. The city remains in ruin as fixing it is considered an act of rebellion and direct violence against the King. [The Moon Dance](#) is incredibly important here as it is the one time of year that the [The Floating Mountain King](#) is "in night". We're able to get close to the edge of the kingdom with the ship.

[Bigby the Big Bismuth Dragon](#) stays on the ship to avoid being spotted. Beau suggests we go to a travel outpost. The journey is miserable, the sand is bright white due to salt flats in the area. A group of joyful kids run past with clown makeup on going towards the city.

We hear carnival music and cheer as we approach the trading outpost. We see [Absol](#) in costume on a stage, and Meta as the carnival master. [The God of Knowledge](#) goes to talk to a naked mole rat off to the side of the carnival. They learn that security is really tight around the Moon Dance and something is just different here.

[Solris](#) goes to look for transportation for the group and finds a dung beetle on top of a giant sphere of shit, a very lavish scorpion, and an extremely long centipede that *will* bite you if you get near the head. The scorpion is owned by a very eccentric cat. Solris does what he has to do to secure the scorpion ride.

[Percival \(REDACTED\)](#), [The Forgotten](#) gets an 8 to ask who's in charge right now and is told that the academy or the Floating Mountain king is in charge, but gets the sense that something else has been toppled.

The Kingdom

When we enter the kingdom we see a tall tower in the distance, the tallest structure we have ever seen. The tower is ovular and floats above the ground. The majority of the city is floating somewhat. The tower seems very organized and intentional while the rest of the city is more or less a wreck. [Beau](#) tells us that this the academy. The top part of the tower is the First Moth Tower and another port from the town, below that is the theater-observatory-library, below that there is an office space where most of the political talks happen, then the main education space, then the port, the rose stage, the sewers, and the catacombs. It looks like the building was meant to float, but wasn't properly built for that.

There are already a lot of airships at the port in preparation for [The Moon Dance](#). [Solris](#) knows that a lot of information passes through the first moth tower, especially about [The Floating Mountain King](#) and getting up there could reveal a lot about the inner workings of the operation. Beau takes us towards the tower through a back alley route and says he needs to step away to talk to a friend who may put us up for the night. The door opens to a blue tiger who looks exasperated and asks what Beau needs.

"You don't have to forgive me for what I did, but would you be willing to put my friends up for the night"

The blue tiger lets us inside, but wants to talk to Beau alone. When we enter Omar's house we see so many shelves and hangings of various trinkets and a pile of various papers in the corner. When [Percival \(REDACTED\)](#), [The Forgotten](#) walks past the papers they see a small memorial for Alexander Abdelhamid: the man he was rumored to kill. Percival decides to stop wearing his mask for now as his face is less recognizable. [The God of Knowledge](#) also stops wearing their hood

After about an hour Beau and Omar walk back into the room, both of them are teary eyed. Omar tells us that he is unable to put us up for the night, but his family could. Omar doesn't seem to put off by the sight of Knowledge. When they see this the word RUN flashes across their face.

When we leave [Beau](#) looks terrified. Beau explains that the last time they saw each other Beau had killed someone in front of him, and Omar didn't know how to process that. The victim was someone at the academy who discovered [Kago](#) and had threatened to tell [The Floating Mountain King](#) about her. Beau chose to explain violence and the true nature of the world over tea, but it seemed like he already knew and understand. Beau gets the sense that something has changed at the academy and that the ambassadors are planning to reveal something at [The Moon Dance](#).

We haven't found any bones in Gyza, but Kago gets the sense that there are a lot in the tower. Beau theorizes that the bones might be what will be revealed. We are not the only players in this game. Beau thinks that being around the bones may also awaken someone to the reality of the world.

We find an inn to stay at. When Hira checks in with Beau he still seems scared with not knowing what to come.

[Percival \(REDACTED\)](#), [The Forgotten](#) visits where the house used to be and finds scorched earth with nothing left but a pond with a small stone. He places his pink orchid there with it.

The Moon Dance

The party decides to split into two groups to explore the tower. [Hira](#), [The Author](#), [Percival \(REDACTED\)](#), [The Forgotten](#), and [Kago](#) will explore the bottom levels while [The God of Knowledge](#), [Solris](#), and [Beau](#).

Downstairs

They make it past one level before getting into a scuffle with the guards, each takt 1 point of damage.

Upon reaching the sewers they hear a screech of attacking bugs. [Percival \(REDACTED\)](#), [The Forgotten](#) offers the attacking bugs some weed scones. The closest cockroach considers, then bites for 1 point of damage. [The Author](#) attempts to persuade the bugs to leave, but they seem

to be defending something here. [Hira](#) is able to use her magic to control the water into drowning one of the bugs. They spot a huge jelly eggsac near the back of the room. The Author attempts to use the liccoice stick on a beg, but it backfires into the author getting covered with poison vomit for 1 damage. As they get closer to the eggs, the more enraged the big bug gets.

Upstairs

We investigate the first floor and find a printing press with tons of pamphlets and papers of propaganda about [The Floating Mountain King](#). [Solris](#) grabs a pin to show visible support. We catch sight of Omar coming towards us.

We reach the Dramtorium and hear loud conversation. In the Dramatorium proper we see a presentation on bridges using constellations as a background. We notice the gods from earlier are hear pouring through the books trying to learn anything they possibly can. Knowledge approaches the god of hospitality and hope who seems enraptured by the presentation. They says that the academy has set up "something special for us". Knowledge tries to tell then that they heard it'll be bad, Hospitality seems confused. Solris gets the sense that there is someone else here. They venture to the grand balcony and immediately starts madly blushing upon seeing an incredibly beautiful bunny who looks pleasant. She's very feminine, except for the fact she is wearing a codpiece.

Solris attempts to throw a pencil to keep The King from noticing Knowledge, but fails and gets the attention of the guards instead. The presentation has also stopped